

HONOR IN BAKING



By Misheck Mwanza (Mishcool)

DEFINITION OF BAKING

Baking is a method of cooking food using dry heat, usually in an oven. It is commonly used to prepare bread, cakes, scones, pies, and other flour-based foods.

IMPORTANCE OF BAKING

Provides nutritious food

Builds life skills

Saves money

Encourages cleanliness and discipline

Promotes healthy eating

WHOLE WHEAT FLOUR VS WHITE FLOUR

Whole Wheat Flour

Made from the whole grain

Rich in fiber and nutrients

Healthier choice

White Flour

Refined grain

Less nutrients

Softer texture

EFFECTS OF YEAST

Makes dough rise

Softens bread

Improves flavor

PREPARATION OF BAKED FOODS USING AN OVEN

1. PREPARATION OF CAKE (USING OVEN)

Ingredients: • Flour • Sugar • Eggs • Butter or oil • Milk or water • Baking flavor • Baking powder

Step-by-Step Preparation:

1. Preheat oven to 170–180°C for about 10 minutes
2. Grease baking pan with oil or butter and dust lightly with flour
3. Mix sugar and butter until creamy
4. Add eggs one by one and mix well
5. Add milk slowly while stirring
6. Sift flour and baking powder together
7. Add dry mixture slowly to wet mixture and mix gently
8. Pour batter into baking pan
9. Bake for 30–40 minutes
10. Test with toothpick – if clean, cake is ready

Common Mistakes & Solutions: • Cake sinking – oven too hot or opening oven early → Keep correct temperature and don't open early • Hard cake – too much flour → Measure properly • Burnt top – oven too hot → Lower temperature

2. PREPARATION OF BREAD (USING OVEN)

Ingredients: • Flour • Yeast • Warm water • Sugar • Salt • Oil or butter

Step-by-Step Preparation:

1. Mix warm water, sugar, and yeast
2. Leave for 5–10 minutes until foamy
3. Add flour, salt, and oil
4. Knead dough for 10 minutes until soft
5. Cover and let rise for 1 hour
6. Knead again lightly
7. Shape into loaf
8. Put in greased pan
9. Let rise again for 30 minutes
10. Bake at 180°C for 30–35 minutes

Common Mistakes & Solutions: • Bread not rising – yeast dead or water too hot → Use warm water (not hot) • Dense bread – not kneaded enough → Knead well

3. PREPARATION OF SCONES (USING OVEN)

Ingredients: • Flour • Baking powder • Sugar • Butter • Milk • Salt

Step-by-Step Preparation:

1. Preheat oven to 200°C
2. Mix flour, sugar, salt, and baking powder
3. Rub butter into flour until crumbly
4. Add milk slowly and mix into soft dough
5. Roll dough lightly
6. Cut into shapes
7. Place on baking tray
8. Bake for 12–15 minutes

Common Mistakes & Solutions: • Hard scones – over mixing → Mix gently • Flat scones – old baking powder → Use fresh baking powder

SAFETY RULES IN BAKING

✓ Use oven gloves ✓ Keep water away from hot oven ✓ Don't touch hot trays ✓ Turn off oven after use ✓ Keep children away

GENERAL BAKING TIPS

• Measure ingredients correctly • Preheat oven always • Follow temperature guides • Keep oven door closed during baking

Use oven gloves

Do not touch hot trays

Turn off oven after use

Keep children away

Keep water away from oven

CONCLUSION

Baking is an important skill that helps prepare healthy food when done properly using correct methods and safety.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. What is baking?

2. State two importance of baking

3. Difference between whole wheat and white flour

4. What is the work of yeast?

5. Outline steps of preparing cake

6. Name two safety rules

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